Matt and Ben

By Mindy Kalling and Brenda Withers

CASTING NOTE from the Authors:
The roles of Matt Damon and Ben Affleck are played by two women

BEN: *(both actors speak to the audience)* Would you believe a package would fall from the sky?

MATT: From the ceiling!

BEN: Into our laps?

MATT: How does a package fall from the ceiling?

BEN: But it did.

MATT: That's the thing, it did!

BEN: Amazing things do happen.

MATT: All the time.

BEN: We realize this.

MATT: But not magical things.

BEN: Like packages falling from the sky-

MATT: From the ceiling!

BEN: But it happened to us.

MATT: We didn't know what it was.

BEN: Or where it came from.

MATT: I was scared.

BEN: Matt was scared. Really scared.

MATT: But then we realized that there was no one here and we didn't have to whisper anymore and we could talk in our normal voices.

BEN: JUST TO BE CERTAIN THERE WAS NO ONE THERE; WE ACTUALLY TALKED MUCH LOUDER THAN USUAL. *(to Matt)* "HEY, WHERE'D THIS COME FROM?"

MATT: I DON'T KNOW BUT IT FELL RIGHT NEXT TO MY GUN!

BOTH: *(to audience)* The mystery begins.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *It's the story Hollywood has glamorized, publicized, and bombarded us with—*
ACTOR 2: *How it all began for the two young men, now famous for their on-again-off-again romances and their big-budget smashes and flops.*
ACTOR 1: *It started with a script for Good Will Hunting,*
ACTOR 2: *Slaved over by the bright young dreamers in their run-down apartment in 1996.*
TOGETHER: *Or was it? Matt and Ben by Mindy Kalling and Brenda Withers*

BEN: Not ticking.

MATT: Not a bomb.

BEN: Not moving.

MATT: Not an animal.

BEN: Not burning.

MATT: Not on fire.

BOTH: Where did it come from?

MATT: We searched the entire apartment. Couch!

BEN: Fine!

MATT: Window.

BEN: Fine!

MATT: Ceiling.

BEN: Fine!

MATT: But it fell from the ceiling.

BEN: Well . . . I'm looking at the ceiling.

MATT: And?

BOTH: Nothing.

MATT: Where did it come from?

BEN: We knew we had to open it. Who would do the honors?

MATT: No way.

BEN: So I opened it. "Good Will Hunting."

MATT: "By Matt Damon . . . and Ben Affleck." Is this a joke?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

BOTH: We wrote a script? *(Matt begins reading the script as Ben tries to read over his shoulder in an aggressive and physical manner)*

MATT: Ow.

BEN: Done?

MATT: No.

BEN: Are you finished yet?

MATT: Stop it! This is an excellent script. It's the best I've ever read.*(to audience)* If Ben put this here, if Ben wrote this, I have severely underestimated his talents. *(Ben has lost interest in Matt's reading and is attempting to drink an entire soda in one drink)*

BEN: Hey, check this out! All in one sip!

MATT: *(to audience)* Ben did not write this. *(to Ben)* I'm done.

BEN: It's so good. *(talking about the soda)*

MATT: It's really good. *(talking about the soda)*

BEN: It's so good, it's so good, it's so good! *(talking about the soda while punching Matt in the arm)*

MATT: Ben, don't hit me.

BEN: Sorry.

MATT: I'm littler than you.

BEN: I know . . . It's so good! *(talking about the soda)*

MATT: It's kind of too good.

BEN: *(Ben dials the phone to call his brother)* Case! Casey, you will not believe what happened to us.

MATT: Ben!

BEN: *(on the phone)* Yeah. Uh huh. No, listen. We were sitting on the couch today-

MATT: Ben, hang up!

BEN: What?

MATT: Hang up the phone!

BEN: Why?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

MATT: Hang up the phone! *(Matt goes to the apartment door to lock it)*

BEN: *(on the phone)* Okay, okay. Uh . . . Casey I have this problem with call waiting, beep, just hold on . . . beep . . . I gotta get that, we might get disconnected so just . . . *(to Matt)* What was that about? Why are you locking the door?

MATT: You can't tell everyone, Ben.

BEN: He's my brother.

MATT: This is very confusing. We don't need to involve everyone.

BEN: What's confusing?

MATT: Ben, where do you think the script came from?

BEN: The hand of God. Where do you think it came from?

MATT: I also think God . . . don't you find that strange?

BEN: Yes.

MATT: It's amazing.

BEN: It's a blessing.

MATT: It's a gift . . . unless . . . have you ever done anything really bad?

BEN: It's not a curse!

MATT: Why not?

BEN: Because it's not!

MATT: Well, it could be a curse. Like Job? Who brags about his family and gets plagued by locust and boils!

BEN: What do we have to brag about?

MATT: C'mon, we're white, male, American . . . we're in *School Ties* !

BEN: It's not a curse.

MATT: No not a curse, but maybe a test. Think about it -- all that you and I want is what?

BEN: Steak sandwiches!

MATT: Not right this instant.

BEN: Cable TV

MATT: More long term.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

BEN: Sony . . .

MATT: Sony Playstation, No.

BEN: Money, an Oscar, a girlfriend, and Casey to lose his speech impediment.

MATT: Right, fame, sex, riches, those are all sins. We're supposed to say no to this. We're supposed to take the script and get rid of it.

BEN: Absolutely not! I hope your messing around!

MATT: No, really, why do we deserve this? We don't. See? It's just like Job.

BEN: We're nothing like Job!

MATT: Not literally, but metaphorically . . . in terms of a metaphor. *(puzzled look from Ben)* Okay, a metaphor is a figure of speech used to compare -

BEN: I know what a metaphor is.

MATT: No, right, but if I were to use "like" or "as" then it would be-

BEN: I know what a simile is too, I just don't get what you're talking about since none of this stuff happened to us!

MATT: I know! That's why it's a metaphor! It's not an exact replica of the situation, it's a comparison-

BEN: I know what a metaphor is!

MATT: Apparently not!

BEN: What is your problem?

MATT: My problem is that every time I try to talk to you about something serious-

BEN: Like something Lala Land-

MATT: No, something serious, you don't even have the vocabulary to discuss it!

BEN: That's not true!

MATT: Yes, it is! You dismiss every conversation, every discussion, if it has even slightly complex ramifications!

BEN: Okay, let's have it your way, Matt Damon Serious Time. *(Sarcastically)* Matt, I'm so scared of this scary script! What are we gonna do? I mean, what are we gonna do?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

MATT: Wow, see? You're proving my point, proving my point. With every word, you're proving my point!

BEN: Proving my point, proving my point, proving my point-

MATT: This is not a joke!

BEN: I know that!

MATT: Oh, really?

BEN: Yes, really. And to be honest, I'm not the one messing around here. I mean, what's the point of this conversation? We're not gonna throw it away. I'm not, and I'm not gonna let you . . . Anyways, Matt, if it's a curse, we're cursed. We can't just put it in the garbage can and just the garbage be cursed. Because the garbage is touching the floor of the apartment where we are standing. And if we throw it away, it'll just go to some dump, which will still be near us, and still on the planet earth. And the only way to get away from that would be to float, or hover above the crust of the earth. So, unless you have a rocket ship or something . . . but the point is, we can't run away from this, or fly away from this, whatever it is. Your name's on it, my name's on it. We just have to deal with it.

MATT: I guess.

BEN: And the curse is wondering about it later if we never do it.

MATT: That's true.

BEN: Okay?

MATT: Yeah. It's just-

BEN: Matt!!

MATT: Then we need to do it right.

BEN: Of course.

MATT: And that's going to be difficult.

BEN: Oh, my God.

MATT: We have to get a director.

BEN: Yes.

MATT: And the right location and cast.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

BEN: Uh, huh.

MATT: Plus a crew! I mean, do you know any grips?

BEN: Nope.

MATT: Are you even listening to me, Ben?

BEN: Yup.

MATT: No you're not.

BEN: Well, it's just that you're preaching at my face about how to make a movie. I've been in a movie.

MATT: But you haven't made a movie.

BEN: Neither have you.

MATT: Okay so we both should be concerned, about getting this just right, because we both have to acknowledge that this doesn't just happen to everyone-

BEN: Okay, I will. I gotcha!

MATT: You will what?

BEN: I will be perfect. I will make a perfect movie with you.

MATT: That's not what I mean.

BEN: Then what do you mean? What?

MATT: Remember senior year? The talent show?

BEN: Yeah, we rocked it! *(Ben freezes in "rocker mode")*

MATT: *(to audience)* Regardless of the fact that I didn't write one word of this script, and that my best friend is a complete idiot, I had to do Good Will Hunting. Good things come in strange packages. Who knows? If it hadn't been for Ben, I might not have been in the right place at the right time. Sure, I'll do it. So long as my name comes first.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Mindy Kaling and Brenda Withers
ISBN: 978-1585675715
Publisher: Overlook Press
Date (Month/Year): Sept 2004

AWARD HISTORY

IL State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY